

IT'S A MATTER
OF LIFE...Gerry
Hostetler

Paysour held fast to his beliefs

He believed — no, he *knew* — that every life needs a stable base, just as every building must have a good foundation. These truths he knew both as a father and as a professional brick mason.

Eulas Samuel Paysour, who still practiced his trade at age 79, died July 22 of cancer and emphysema. He was finishing up the brick chimney on a new home when his illnesses were diagnosed a month ago.

Grandson Kara Paysour will take over his grandfather's business and will, for sure, complete the chimney.



Eulas Paysour

Hands of an artist

"He was such an artist with his hands," said oldest son Stephen Paysour.

GASTON COUNTY

Hawk to be tested for West Nile virus

*Raptor Center volunteer
unable to determine
cause of death for bird*

BY JOE DEPRIEST
Staff Writer

STANLEY — As a precaution, a small hawk found in the driveway of a Stanley residence will be tested for the potentially fatal West Nile virus.

Results should be back from the National Wildlife Health Center in Madison, Wis., in about two weeks, officials said Friday.

The sharp-skinned hawk was alive when discovered Thursday, but it had died by the time a volunteer arrived from the Carolina Raptor Center.

The bird attracted a resident's attention because it was unable to

fly.

Even though there's no evidence the hawk actually had the virus, which is thought to be carried by birds and transmitted by mosquitoes, officials want to make sure.

"To be on the safe side, it's being tested," said Curtis Hopper, Gaston's environmental health supervisor. "This is the first one (bird) from Gaston to be tested."

Mathias Engelmann, Carolina Raptor Center rehabilitation coordinator, examined the 4-ounce adult female hawk, but couldn't determine the cause of death.

"We checked it very thoroughly and it had no physical injuries," he said. "That made it a good candidate to be tested."

West Nile, an imported pathogen from the Middle East, wasn't evident in the Western Hemisphere until it popped up in New York City in August 1999. In most

humans, the virus causes no symptoms except for a mild flu-like infection. But in older people with chronic illnesses or impaired immune systems, it can escalate to encephalitis, a potentially fatal swelling of the brain.

With cases of the virus reported north and south of the Carolinas, health officials in both states say the disease is bound to find its way to the region. A crow infected with the virus was found last year in Chatham County, southwest of Raleigh.

The virus infected 62 people in 1999, killing seven. Of the 20 people infected in 2000, two died. The virus was found in 12 states. Although there's no reason to suspect the Gaston bird had West Nile, Engelmann said "We wanted to err on the side of caution."

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